

Intro (brief):

Physical facilities — such as food, water, shelter, clothing and basic healthcare — are the foundation for survival of all living beings. However, while these facilities are generally *sufficient* to meet animals' requirements, they are *necessary but not sufficient* to meet human needs. Humans require additional psychological, social, intellectual and moral resources. Below I expand each side-heading thoroughly, with examples and implications, as required for a long-answer (16 marks).

(i) Why physical facilities are complete for animals

1. Behavioural basis (Instinct-driven life)

Animals' behaviour is largely governed by instinct and fixed patterns (e.g., foraging, mating, sheltering, parental care). Because their decisions follow biological programming rather than reflective thought, the things they require to perform those behaviours are physical: food to eat, water to drink, a safe nest or den, and protection against predators/illness. When these physical conditions are met, animals can carry out their instinctual life-cycles, reproduce and survive — there is little or no unmet “psychological” demand beyond immediate bodily needs.

Example: A bird requires twigs for a nest, seeds for food, and a safe tree. Once those are available, the bird will carry out nesting and feeding behaviours without needing non-physical resources like education or self-identity.

2. Limited needs (Minimal and stable requirements)

Most animals have a narrow range of needs that remain relatively constant across time: nourishment, safety, shelter, mating opportunities. They do not seek abstract goals such as self-fulfilment, prestige, or cultural participation. Because their needs are limited and predictable, providing the corresponding physical facilities is effectively “complete” care for that species.

Example: Livestock on a farm — if given adequate feed, shelter, and veterinary care, their welfare needs (as per their nature) are covered.

3. No higher cognitive demands (Absence of reflective or existential needs)

Animals generally do not possess the same level of reflective consciousness as humans: they do not ask “why” or seek meaning beyond survival and reproduction. Consequently, they do not require education, moral guidance, or social recognition to feel fulfilled. Their welfare is satisfied primarily by meeting material and environmental conditions.

Example: A domesticated dog may form bonds and exhibit emotions, but its primary wellbeing is still strongly dependent on regular feeding, shelter, exercise and safety. (Note: this point acknowledges emotional life in some animals but stresses that complex value-oriented needs typical of humans are largely absent.)

(ii) Why physical facilities are not complete for humans

1. Human consciousness is reflexive (Self-awareness and reflection)

Humans are self-aware: they reflect on past actions, plan for the future, and ask existential questions about purpose and meaning. This reflexive consciousness creates needs that are not material — such as the need for identity, purpose, dignity, and mental peace. Physical facilities alone cannot satisfy these demands.

Example: A person with all material comforts may still feel purposeless or anxious if they lack meaningful work or relationships.

2. Qualitative needs (Emotional and social dimensions)

Humans require emotional security (love, belonging), social recognition (respect, status), and psychological wellbeing (self-esteem, mental health). These are qualitative needs — they cannot be fulfilled by material goods alone. Social relationships, affirmation, and psychological support are essential components of a complete human life.

Example: Two households with identical incomes can have very different outcomes: a supportive family environment fosters wellbeing, whereas toxic relationships lead to distress despite material adequacy.

3. Value orientation (Ethics, beliefs, culture)

Humans organize life around values, ethics, norms and cultural practices. People need frameworks to interpret right and wrong, to make moral choices, and to pursue ideals like justice or compassion. These intangible systems of meaning matter for social cohesion and personal satisfaction and cannot be provided by physical infrastructure.

Example: Access to religious, cultural or civic institutions supports identity and purpose beyond material comforts.

4. Development needs (Education, creativity, mental growth)

Human flourishing depends on cognitive development, creativity, education and lifelong learning. These needs foster innovation, critical thinking and emotional intelligence. Physical facilities such as schools, libraries and cultural venues help, but true development requires pedagogy, mentorship, emotional nurturing and opportunities to practice skills — all of which are non-material.

Example: A child given nutritious food and shelter but denied schooling and stimulation will not achieve cognitive or social development comparable to a child who receives both physical and developmental support.

(iii) Examples to illustrate the difference

1. Animal example (Simple fulfilment through physical provisioning)

A cow in a village: provided with adequate grazing land, water, shelter and veterinary care, the cow will thrive, give milk, reproduce and maintain health. There is rarely a need to address “meaning” or “social status” for the cow; physical provisioning suffices.

2. Human example (Material sufficiency is not the same as wellbeing)

Consider a factory worker who earns enough to afford housing, food and a phone. Despite material sufficiency, they may experience loneliness, lack of purpose, exploitation at work, or social stigma. To achieve true wellbeing this person needs fair working conditions, social respect, opportunities for skill growth, psychological support and a sense of community — all non-material components.

(iv) Implications for society and policy

1. Welfare policy must be holistic (Beyond material distribution)

Public policy should not only provide physical safety nets (food rations, housing, healthcare) but must also address education, mental health, social integration, and cultural participation. Holistic welfare ensures that citizens develop fully — physically, mentally and socially.

Policy action: Integrate mental health services into primary care; fund community centres and cultural programs alongside food-subsidy schemes.

2. Child development (Early investments in non-physical needs)

Children need early stimulation, nurturing care, education, and emotional bonding to reach their developmental potential. Programs like early childhood education, parental counseling, and play-based learning are as important as nutrition.

Policy action: Invest in Anganwadi/early childhood centers that provide both nutrition and early learning; parent-support programs to encourage positive caregiving.

3. Ethics and laws (Protecting dignity and social values)

Laws and institutions should protect dignity, equality and rights — not only property or material entitlements. Promoting civic values, anti-discrimination protections, labor rights and access to justice supports non-material needs essential for a stable society.

Policy action: Strengthen labor protections, ensure anti-discrimination enforcement, promote civic education that builds shared values.

4. Mental health and community cohesion (Social infrastructure matters)

Government and civil society should build social infrastructure — parks, libraries, cultural spaces, clubs — that foster community ties and mental wellbeing. Community networks reduce isolation and enhance resilience.

Policy action: Fund community mental-health programs, support arts and local associations, and encourage community-based participatory projects.

Conclusion (concise)

Physical facilities are indispensable for both animals and humans, but they are **sufficient** for animals while **insufficient** for humans. Human wellbeing is multi-dimensional: material needs must be paired with emotional, social, intellectual and ethical supports. Therefore, individuals, communities and policy-makers must adopt a holistic approach that combines physical provisioning with development of mind, values and social bonds.